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response to covert operations

- Develop the capabilities of states to respond to intelligence inputs.
- IB must start 38 intelligence schools in all the states.
- Complete standardisation of operating procedures, equipment.
- Central law that gives an executive power to a special force throughout the country.
- A comprehensive law to cover gun running, hawala transactions, money laundering and drugs.
- Should create a homeland security or a national counter-terrorism agency.
- Have an objective assessment of the threat.
- Have objective assessment of the resources required.
- Work hard on the acquisition of all these resources.
- Finally, we need to deploy these resources in a coherent strategic framework.

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We need to conduct surgical strikes in Pakistan-Occupied Kashmir (POK) which we claim as our own territory. We need to strike the leadership and headquarters of the non state actors and call Pakistan's nuclear bluff. You cannot compare yourself with Pakistan at the operational level where the military runs the show. Here, you have decent people running the nation. We need to involve people in giving in-

formation. When Rajiv Gandhi was assassinated, we created a hotline for people to call in with information. We got a thousand calls a day and finally got them. Punjab terrorism was sorted out by the Punjab Police with the help of the people of Punjab.

There is talk of proliferating the NSG. Special forces are offensive troops, they are specifically selected and specially trained. You cannot have them proliferating. I could not raise 500 special forces men of the required calibre and there is talk of raising NSG all over the country, just because they couldn't be mobilised in time from Delhi? In my time we had a high level of readiness at the NSG. We checked where our troops were every day, where the aircraft was and whether it was ready to take off, and if it wasn't, if we could deposition civil aircraft. During the attempted coup in Maldives, the NSG mobilised eight hours ahead of the Indian Army. As for police training and equipment, you need just one .303 bullet from a well trained policeman to kill a terrorist whether he is carrying a bazooka or an AK-47.

Ajai Sahni: There are no out of the box solutions. The solutions are inside the box. The objective of all the initiatives

incapacities. The NIA as a response to terrorism is laughable. The FBI has a budget of \$7.2 billion while you have opened a grocery store for Rs 10 crore per annum, with nine people who don't have an office to sit in. We are in a protracted war model with Pakistan and the talk of a negotiated solution reflects a level of national imbecility which is completely incomprehensible after 60 years of hostility. We only have opinions.

Unless we start attacking the endurance of the Pakistani Army and the ISI over an extended period of time, we are not going to secure peace in this region. We are not responding to the realities of what Pakistan is and what it is trying to do. We fly down to Lahore or Islamabad. They talk nicely, we have ghazal evenings, we say we are the same people. This is rubbish. You can never have peace through peace processes. You can only have peace if you understand the realities of war. That does not mean we must not talk. But to believe that through talks you can secure something that is impossible to secure through a rational calculus of the distribution of power between the conflicting parties.

Here the rational calculus will include not just troops and tanks but the ques-

The experts were unanimous in
their opinion that the IPL should have
been held in India. Sending it abroad
puts out the wrong signals.

that have been taken, all announcements made in the past three months have not been to address the problem of terrorism, they have been to contain the political fallout of the Mumbai attacks and the embarrassment caused to the political leadership.

You can't derive lessons of Mumbai until you do a minute-to-minute analysis of the response of the agencies involved, of the particular nodes of failure, of the existing capacities or

tion of will and audacity. Wars have been won purely on audacity, irrespective of the distribution of power. We have 1.2 billion sitting here, Pakistan has 175 million. America can't really touch Pakistan. They will do harm, they will kill a few people, but they are willing to take those deaths. So, we were in need to get back to a very much more fundamental calculus, to understand what are the capacities and the actions that are